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EYE-36
Version 1.0

PATIENT HANDOUT · CATARACT & LENS SURGERY

After Your Eye Surgery: Instructions & Drop Schedule

Keep this sheet with your eye drops and bring it to every visit.

Completed by: Clinician (give to patient) | Use as: Document / handout | Time: —

01 Your surgery

Patient name

Eye operated ○ Right ○ Left

Surgery date

Surgeon

Day 1 visit

Week 1 visit

Month 1 visit

Next visit

02 Your eye drops

Drop	Cap colour	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Then
A — antibiotic		× / day	× / day	× / day	× / day	
B — steroid / anti-inflammatory		× / day	× / day	× / day	× / day	
C — NSAID / other		× / day	× / day	× / day	× / day	

- Wash your hands, tilt your head back, pull the lower lid down and place **one drop** in the pocket. Wait **5 minutes** between different drops; don't let the bottle tip touch your eye or lashes.
- Shake suspension drops (often the steroid) first. Keep using usual glaucoma drops unless told otherwise. If you miss a dose, use it when you remember — don't double up.

Week 1 tick chart	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5	Day 6	Day 7
Breakfast	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C
Lunch	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C
Dinner	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C
Bedtime	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C	☐A ☐B ☐C

03 Do's and don'ts

	You can	Please avoid
First week	Read, watch TV, use screens, walk, shower (keep water out of the eye), light chores	Rubbing the eye · sleeping without the shield · eye make-up · dusty places
First 2 weeks	Gentle exercise; short flights if your surgeon agrees	Swimming, hot tubs · heavy lifting, strenuous exercise · gardening
Driving	Once your vision meets the legal standard and your surgeon agrees	Driving on the day of surgery

Wear the eye shield at night for ____ nights

Return to work

Other instructions

04 When to call us

Urgent

Mild grittiness, watering and blur are normal for a few days; new glasses are usually prescribed 4–6 weeks after surgery. Call **immediately** — day or night — if you have: **increasing pain** not relieved by paracetamol / acetaminophen, **worsening vision**, **increasing redness**, **discharge or swelling**, **flashes, a shower of floaters or a curtain / shadow**, or **nausea and vomiting with eye pain**.

Clinic phone (hours)

After-hours / on-call number

Nearest emergency department